BME 707 / 708 - MS Project – Spring 2026
Tuesday/Thursday, 5:05PM -6:20PM, McArthur Eng 216
Course Syllabus

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Course description: The goal of the MS project is to train students to solve complex scientific or technical problems at the interface of engineering and medicine or biology. The M.S. project can be a research or design project. The project must include a significant research or design component contributed by the M.S. student, including, but not limited to, the design of an experiment or process; the development of a device, instrument, or system; the development of a computer program; the analysis of experimental data. Projects cannot be limited solely to the review of literature, the development of research or design proposals, or the collection of experimental data.

Project mentor: Students identify a project mentor that will supervise the student's work. The project mentor will assign a project, provide training in the relevant topics, meet at least weekly with the student to give feedback and monitor progress, and critically review and approve interim and final reports and presentations. The project mentor is generally a primary BME faculty member, but students may also complete their project under the supervision of a faculty member from another department or from the local biomedical industry under the following conditions:

- The student must receive the approval of the Graduate Program Director or Department Chairman.
- The student must identify a co-mentor who must be a primary BME faculty member. The co-mentor must be familiar with the topic of the proposed project. The role of the co-mentor will be to monitor the student progress and ensure that the project report and presentation satisfy all of the relevant requirements.

Project coordinators: The project coordinators are the instructors on record for the BME 707 and 708 course. The role of the project coordinators is to:

- Help students identify a project and mentor.
- Ensure that the projects satisfy the program objectives.
- Provide general guidance and graduate scholarship training.
- Monitor the students and ensure that they are making progress towards the project goals.
- Assign the final grade, with input from the project mentor.

Assessment: Students submit a written report and give an oral presentation at the end of the semester. The BME 707/708 report and presentation must describe the objectives and significance of the work, the project plan and expected outcomes, and preliminary results. The report must demonstrate that the work performed by the student satisfies the general project criteria. The progress report for the completion of BME 707 should be 5-6 pages. If the project resulted in the submission of a full-length peer-reviewed scientific article, the article can be submitted in lieu of a report, as long as the following conditions are satisfied:

- The student must be the first author of the article.
- The article must reflect the work performed by the student as part of the project.
- The article must be submitted for publication in a peer-reviewed journal or conference proceedings volume.
- A one to two page introduction must be submitted to summarize the project goals and main outcomes.

The report must be reviewed and approved by the project mentor (and co-mentor, if any). Once the report is approved by the mentor(s), an electronic version in PDF format must be submitted to the Project Coordinator by the specified deadline. The final report must be approved and signed by the Project Mentor(s), Project Coordinator, and Graduate Program Director or Department Chair.

Project grade: The final grade is given by the project coordinators in consultation with the project mentor. The final grade takes into account the overall performance of the student on the project and the quality of the oral presentation and report. Students who are not able to complete their project requirements, including a final presentation and submission of a final approved report, by the due dates will receive an "I" grade. Students who make unsatisfactory progress will receive an "F" grade.

Project milestones:

The key project deadlines and milestones are listed below. Outside of the dates below, the course coordinators will meet individually with students on a weekly or bi-weekly basis to review progress.

1/13	Group meeting – Introduction and review of course objectives and structure.
1/20	Project update presentations: 5 min (BME 708). All BME 708 students will present. All BME 707 and BME 708 students are expected to attend.
2/03	Project mentor and topic identified (BME 707) – Project abstract is due via Blackboard. The abstract must be reviewed and approved by project mentor.
2/17	Detailed project plan is due via Blackboard. The plan must be reviewed and approved by the project mentor before submission.
2/24	Mid-term presentations BME 708 and BME 707 (5 min presentations + 5 min discussion) All BME 707 and BME 708 students are expected to attend. Students present the project goals, background and significance, proposed plan, and expected outcomes/deliverables. Presentation must be reviewed and approved by project mentor and submitted to the project coordinators before 2/24.
3/3	Mid-term presentations BME 707 (5 min presentations + 5 min discussion) All BME 707 and BME 708 students are expected to attend. Students present the project goals, background and significance, proposed plan, and expected outcomes/deliverables. Presentation must be reviewed and approved by project mentor and submitted to the project coordinators before 3/3.
3/24	Draft of the report is due via Blackboard for all BME 707 and BME 708 students. The draft report must be reviewed and approved by the project mentor before submission. The project coordinators will review the draft and provide feedback to the students.
4/21	End-of-semester presentations – 5:00-7:30PM All BME 707 and BME 708 students are expected to attend. Presentations must be reviewed and approved by the project mentor and submitted to the project coordinators before 4/21. BME 708 students who are completing their project in Spring 2026 will give their final project presentation. BME 707 students will give a progress update.
4/27	Final report is due. The report must be reviewed and approved by the project mentor before submission. BME 708 students must submit their final project report. Students who submit their reports past the due date may receive an "F". BME 707 students must submit a progress report including a plan for BME 708 semester.

Templates for the abstract and for the cover page of the report are provided on the following pages.

UNIVERSITY OF MIAMI
DEPARTMENT OF BIOMEDICAL ENGINEERING

BME 707 - MS PROJECT ABSTRACT

Date:

Student Name:

Project mentor: *Provide Name, Title, Department*

Project coordinator: *Provide Name, Title, Department*

Project description (100 to 200 words): *Provide a brief description of the project, including: overall project goals; the proposed tasks, experiments or design concept to be implemented; and the project deliverables (what is the expected outcome of the project). Be as specific as you can.*

Approved:

_____ _____

Project Mentor Project Coordinator

UNIVERSITY OF MIAMI
DEPARTMENT OF BIOMEDICAL ENGINEERING

MS PROJECT REPORT
submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of
Master of Science in Biomedical Engineering

TITLE SHOULD BE IN ALL CAPS AND SINGLE SPACED IF IT WRAPS AROUND – NO BOLD

Jane Doe

Project supervised by: John Smith, PhD

Approved:

_____	_____
Project Mentor, Degree	Project Coordinator, Degree
Title	Title
Department of Biomedical Engineering	Department of Biomedical Engineering

_____
Department Chair or Graduate Program Director
Title
Department of Biomedical Engineering

Date: